

Step-by-Step Build Guide · For Non-Tech People

# Lead Generation AI Automation

Build It From Scratch in 60 Minutes

A complete, crystal-clear guide to building an AI-powered lead generation automation that finds potential customers, qualifies them with AI, and delivers hot leads to you automatically.

## Tools We'll Use:

Make.com

ChatGPT / OpenAI

Google Sheets

Email (Gmail)

Typeform or Google Forms

No coding required. Just follow each step exactly.

# Table of Contents

---

1. What We're Building (The Big Picture)  
.....
2. What is Lead Generation Automation?  
.....
3. The Complete Flow Diagram  
.....
4. Before You Start (Setup Checklist)  
.....
5. Step-by-Step: Create the Lead Capture Form  
.....
6. Step-by-Step: Connect Make.com to Your Form  
.....
7. Step-by-Step: Add AI to Qualify Leads  
.....
8. Step-by-Step: Route Leads (Hot vs Cold)  
.....
9. Step-by-Step: Auto-Email Hot Leads  
.....
10. Step-by-Step: Save Everything to Google Sheets  
.....
11. Step-by-Step: Test Your Automation  
.....
12. Step-by-Step: Turn It On (Go Live)  
.....
13. How to Improve It Over Time  
.....
14. How to Sell This to Clients (\$1,500+)  
.....
15. Troubleshooting Common Problems  
.....

# 1. What We're Building (The Big Picture)

*Before we touch any tool, let's understand what we're creating and WHY it's valuable.*

## The Problem We're Solving

A business gets 50+ form submissions per day from their website. Manually reading each one, deciding who is a "hot lead" (ready to buy) vs "cold lead" (just browsing), and then following up takes **3+ hours every single day**.

**Our automation does all of this in seconds, 24/7, with zero human effort.**

## What the Automation Does (In Plain English)

1

### Someone fills out a form on the business website

They enter their name, email, budget, what service they need, and a message.

2

### AI reads their answers and scores them 1-10

Based on budget, urgency, and fit, AI decides: Is this person likely to buy? Score 8+? Hot lead. Score below 5? Cold lead.

3

### Hot leads get an instant personalized email

Within 60 seconds of submitting the form, they get a friendly email: "Hi [name], thanks for reaching out! Based on what you shared, I'd love to schedule a quick call..."

4

### Cold leads get a different nurture email

A softer email with helpful resources: "Hi [name], here's a free guide that might help you..."

5

### All leads are saved to Google Sheets with their score

A clean spreadsheet with: Name, Email, Score, Category (Hot/Cold), AI's reasoning, date received.

**Result:** The business owner wakes up every morning to a spreadsheet of pre-scored, pre-contacted leads. They only spend time on the hot ones. This saves 20+ hours/week and increases sales by 30-50%.

## 2. What is Lead Generation Automation?

---

*Breaking it down into simple words.*

### **Lead = A potential customer**

Anyone who shows interest in a business. They filled a form, sent a message, called, or signed up for something.

### **Lead Generation = Finding potential customers**

The process of attracting people who might buy from you. Usually through ads, social media, websites, or referrals.

### **Lead Qualification = Scoring those customers**

Deciding which leads are worth your time. A person with a \$10,000 budget who needs help "this week" is hotter than someone "just looking around."

### **AI Automation = Making AI do all of this automatically**

Instead of a human reading every form and deciding, AI does it instantly, 24/7, without breaks or mistakes.

## Why Businesses Pay Big Money for This

| Without Automation                     | With Your Automation              |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Manually read 50+ forms/day            | AI reads and scores instantly     |
| Takes 3+ hours daily                   | Takes 0 minutes (fully automatic) |
| Responds to leads in 24-48 hours       | Responds in under 60 seconds      |
| Misses hot leads on weekends           | Works 24/7, never misses          |
| Human bias in scoring                  | Consistent AI scoring every time  |
| Costs \$3,000-\$5,000/month (employee) | Costs \$30-\$50/month (tools)     |

**This is why businesses happily pay \$1,500-\$5,000 for this automation.** It replaces a part-time employee and works better.

### 3. The Complete Flow Diagram

Here's the visual map of everything we're building. Refer back to this whenever you feel lost.



#### Detailed Breakdown of Each Step

| Step            | Tool Used               | What Happens                                       |
|-----------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Trigger      | Typeform / Google Forms | Visitor fills form on website                      |
| 2. Receive Data | Make.com (Webhook)      | Make.com receives name, email, budget, message     |
| 3. AI Scoring   | OpenAI (ChatGPT API)    | AI reads all answers, gives score 1-10 + reason    |
| 4. Decision     | Make.com (Router)       | If score >= 7 = Hot. If score < 7 = Cold.          |
| 5a. Hot Path    | Gmail                   | Send personalized "let's talk" email               |
| 5b. Cold Path   | Gmail                   | Send helpful "here's a resource" email             |
| 6. Save         | Google Sheets           | Log everything: name, email, score, category, date |

**Tip:** Print this page and keep it next to you while building. It's your blueprint.

## 4. Before You Start (Setup Checklist)

---

*Get these ready before you begin building. Takes about 15 minutes.*

### Accounts to Create (All Free)

- [ ] Make.com account — go to make.com, click "Get started free"
- [ ] OpenAI account — go to platform.openai.com, sign up (need credit card, but costs pennies)
- [ ] Google account — for Gmail + Google Sheets (you probably have this already)
- [ ] Typeform account — go to typeform.com (free tier) OR use Google Forms (completely free)

### Things to Prepare

- [ ] Decide what business this is for (yours or a client's)
- [ ] Write down: What makes a "hot lead" for this business? (e.g., budget over \$1,000, needs help this month)
- [ ] Write down: What makes a "cold lead"? (e.g., just browsing, no budget, vague timeline)
- [ ] Prepare a short business description (2-3 sentences about what the business does)

## Getting Your OpenAI API Key

**1**

### Go to platform.openai.com

Sign up or log in with your OpenAI/ChatGPT account.

**2**

### Click on "API Keys" in the left sidebar

You'll see a page listing your API keys (probably empty).

**3**

### Click "+ Create new secret key"

Give it a name like "Lead Gen Automation" and click Create.



4

**COPY the key immediately and save it somewhere safe**

It looks like: sk-xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx. You can NEVER see it again after closing the popup. Save it in a note.

**Important:** Never share your API key publicly. It's like a password. Anyone who has it can use your OpenAI account and you'll be charged.

**Cost Estimate**

| Tool                 | Monthly Cost          | Notes                                                            |
|----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Make.com (Free plan) | \$0                   | 1,000 operations/month. Enough for testing + small volume.       |
| OpenAI API           | \$2-\$10              | About \$0.002 per lead scored. 1,000 leads = ~\$2.               |
| Google Sheets        | \$0                   | Free with Google account.                                        |
| Gmail                | \$0                   | Free with Google account.                                        |
| Typeform (Free plan) | \$0                   | 10 responses/month on free. Use Google Forms for unlimited free. |
| <b>TOTAL</b>         | <b>\$2-\$10/month</b> | <b>To run the full automation!</b>                               |

## 5. Step-by-Step: Create the Lead Capture Form

*This is what visitors fill out on the website. It collects the data AI will analyze.*

### Option A: Using Google Forms (Easiest, 100% Free)

- 1

**Go to forms.google.com**  
Click the big "+" button to create a new blank form.
- 2

**Set the title**  
Example: "Get a Free Consultation" or "Request a Quote"
- 3

**Add these questions (in this exact order)**  
This order matters because AI will use all of this to score the lead.

| # | Question                            | Type                                                                                 | Why We Need It            |
|---|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1 | What's your full name?              | Short answer                                                                         | To personalize emails     |
| 2 | What's your email address?          | Short answer                                                                         | To send follow-up         |
| 3 | What's your company/ business name? | Short answer                                                                         | Shows they're serious     |
| 4 | What service are you interested in? | Multiple choice OR short answer                                                      | Tells AI what they want   |
| 5 | What's your approximate budget?     | Multiple choice: Under \$500 / \$500-\$2,000 / \$2,000-\$5,000 / \$5,000+ / Not sure | Key scoring factor        |
| 6 | How soon do you need this?          | Multiple choice: This week / This month / In 2-3 months / Just exploring             | Urgency = hot lead        |
| 7 | Tell us more about what you need    | Paragraph (long answer)                                                              | AI reads this for context |

4

**Make questions 1, 2, 5, and 6 "Required"**

Click on each question, toggle "Required" at the bottom right. These are essential for AI scoring.

5

**Click "Send" and copy the form link**

Save this link. You'll embed it on a website or share it directly.

**Tip:** If using Typeform instead, create the same questions but in Typeform's interface. It looks prettier and gets higher completion rates, but costs money after 10 responses.

## 6. Step-by-Step: Connect Make.com to Your Form

---

*Now we connect the form to Make.com so it receives submissions automatically.*

**1****Log in to Make.com**

Go to make.com and log into your account. You'll see your dashboard.

**2****Click "Create a new scenario"**

A "scenario" = a workflow = your automation. You'll see a blank canvas with a big "+" in the center.

**3****Click the "+" and search for "Google Forms"**

Select the "Google Forms" app from the list.

**4****Select "Watch Responses"**

This means: "Every time someone submits the form, trigger this automation."

**5****Connect your Google account**

Click "Add" next to "Connection." A Google login popup appears. Log in and give permission. This is safe — Make.com needs access to read form responses.

**6****Select your form**

A dropdown will show all your Google Forms. Pick the one you created in Step 5.

**7****Click OK and save**

You now have a purple circle on your canvas. This is the "trigger" — the starting point of your automation.

**What Your Screen Should Look Like:**

A single purple/blue circle labeled "Google Forms - Watch Responses" on a blank white canvas.  
That's it for now.

**Checkpoint:** At this point, whenever someone fills your form, Make.com will "wake up" and start running. But right now it has nothing to do with the data. Let's fix that.

## 7. Step-by-Step: Add AI to Qualify Leads

*This is the brain of the automation. AI will read the form answers and score each lead.*

1

### Click the "+" next to the Google Forms module

This adds a new step AFTER the form trigger.

2

### Search for "OpenAI" and select it

Choose the "OpenAI (ChatGPT, DALL-E, Whisper)" app.

3

### Select "Create a Chat Completion"

This is the action that sends a message to ChatGPT and gets a response back.

4

### Connect your OpenAI account

Click "Add" paste your API key (the one you saved earlier: sk-xxxxx...) click Save.

5

### Select the model: "gpt-4o-mini"

This is the cheapest smart model. It costs about \$0.001 per lead scored. Fast and accurate enough for lead scoring.

6

### Write the System Prompt (THIS IS CRITICAL)

In the "System Message" field, paste the prompt below. This tells AI exactly how to score leads.

**SYSTEM PROMPT — Copy this exactly**

You are a lead qualification expert for a business. Your job is to read a potential customer's form submission and score them from 1 to 10 based on how likely they are to become a paying customer.

#### SCORING RULES:

- Budget \$5,000+ AND needs help this week/month = Score 9-10
- Budget \$2,000-\$5,000 AND needs help this month = Score 7-8
- Budget \$500-\$2,000 AND needs help in 2-3 months = Score 5-6
- Budget under \$500 OR "just exploring" = Score 3-4
- Vague answers, no budget, unclear needs = Score 1-2

You MUST respond in EXACTLY this format (no extra text):

SCORE: [number]

CATEGORY: [Hot/Warm/Cold]

REASON: [one sentence explaining why]

SUGGESTED\_REPLY: [a personalized 2-sentence response to send them]

Categories:

- Score 7-10 = Hot
- Score 4-6 = Warm
- Score 1-3 = Cold

7

### Write the User Message (Form data goes here)

In the "User Message" field, you'll insert the actual form data. Click in the field and use Make.com's data picker to insert variables:

**USER MESSAGE — Use Make.com variables (the purple tags)**

New lead submission:

Name: {{Name}}

Email: {{Email}}

Company: {{Company}}

Service Interested In: {{Service}}

Budget: {{Budget}}

Timeline: {{How soon do you need this?}}

Additional Details: {{Tell us more about what you need}}

Please score this lead.

**How to insert variables:** When you click inside the User Message field in Make.com, you'll see a panel showing data from the previous module (Google Forms). Click each piece of data to insert it. They appear as colored tags like `Name`.

8

### Click OK to save the module

You now have: Form Trigger → AI Scoring. Two modules connected by a line.

**What happens now:** When someone submits the form, AI receives all their answers, thinks about it, and outputs something like:

SCORE: 8

CATEGORY: Hot

REASON: High budget (\$5,000+) with urgent timeline (this week). Clear project description shows readiness to buy.

SUGGESTED\_REPLY: Hi Sarah, thanks for reaching out! Your project sounds exciting and we'd love to help. Let me schedule a quick 15-minute call this week to discuss the details.



## 8. Step-by-Step: Route Leads (Hot vs Cold)

*Now we need to split the path: hot leads go one way, cold leads go another.*

### Understanding the Router

A "Router" in Make.com splits your automation into multiple paths based on conditions. Think of it like a traffic light: green light = go this way, red light = go that way.

1

#### Right-click the line between OpenAI module and the empty space

Or: Click the "+" after the OpenAI module, then search for "Router" in the Tools section.

2

#### Add a Router module

The Router appears as a diamond shape with two (or more) output paths. You'll see two lines coming out of it.

3

#### Set up Path 1: HOT LEADS (score 7+)

Click on the first path line. A filter settings panel opens. Set it up as:

**Label:** Hot Lead

**Condition:** The OpenAI response "contains" "CATEGORY: Hot"

4

#### Set up Path 2: COLD/WARM LEADS

Click on the second path line. Set the filter:

**Label:** Cold/Warm Lead

**Condition:** The OpenAI response "does not contain" "CATEGORY: Hot"

**What this does:** Every time AI scores a lead, the router checks: Did AI say "CATEGORY: Hot"? If yes go to Hot path. If no go to Cold path. Simple!

#### What Your Canvas Should Look Like Now:

[Google Forms] [OpenAI] [Router Diamond] Two paths going in different directions

## 9. Step-by-Step: Auto-Email Hot Leads

*Hot leads get a personalized email within 60 seconds of submitting the form.*

### Path 1: Hot Lead Email

- 1

**On the "Hot Lead" path, click "+" to add a new module**

Search for "Gmail" and select it.
- 2

**Select "Send an Email"**

This will send an email from your Gmail account.
- 3

**Connect your Gmail account**

Click "Add" → log in to Gmail → give permission. Your Gmail is now connected.
- 4

**Fill in the email fields**

Use the data from previous modules (click to insert variables):

| Field   | What to Put                                             |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| To      | {{Email}} (from Google Forms module)                    |
| Subject | Thanks for reaching out, {{Name}}! Let's chat this week |
| Body    | See the template below                                  |

HOT LEAD EMAIL BODY

Hi {{Name}},

Thank you so much for reaching out to us! I just reviewed your inquiry and I'm excited — it sounds like we'd be a great fit for what you need.

{{SUGGESTED\_REPLY from OpenAI}}

You can book a quick 15-minute call directly here: [YOUR BOOKING LINK]

Or simply reply to this email and I'll get back to you within a few hours.

Looking forward to connecting!

Best,

[Your Name]

[Your Business]

**Pro Tip:** Use AI's "SUGGESTED\_REPLY" output directly in the email. It's already personalized based on what the lead wrote! This makes every email feel hand-written.

## Path 2: Cold/Warm Lead Email

5

**On the "Cold/Warm" path, add another Gmail "Send Email" module**

Same process as above, but with a softer, nurturing email:

### COLD/WARM LEAD EMAIL BODY

Hi {{Name}},

Thanks for your interest in our services! I appreciate you taking the time to fill out our form.

Since you mentioned you're still exploring options, I thought you might find this helpful:

[Link to a free guide, blog post, or resource relevant to your business]

When you're ready to move forward, just reply to this email or visit our website to book a free consultation. No pressure at all!

Best regards,

[Your Name]

[Your Business]

6

**Click OK on both email modules**

Both paths now have email actions. Hot leads get an eager response. Cold leads get a gentle nurture.

## 10. Step-by-Step: Save Everything to Google Sheets

*Every lead gets logged in a clean spreadsheet for tracking and follow-up.*

### First: Create Your Google Sheet

1

**Go to [sheets.google.com](https://sheets.google.com) and create a new spreadsheet**

Name it "Lead Tracker" or "AI Lead Scores"

2

**Add these column headers in Row 1**

Type exactly these in cells A1 through H1:

| A    | B    | C     | D       | E      | F     | G        | H         |
|------|------|-------|---------|--------|-------|----------|-----------|
| Date | Name | Email | Company | Budget | Score | Category | AI Reason |

### Now: Add Google Sheets Module in Make.com

3

**On BOTH paths (hot and cold), add a Google Sheets module AFTER the email module**

Click "+" after each Gmail module   search "Google Sheets"   select "Add a Row"

4

**Connect your Google account (if not already connected)**

Same as before — log in and give permission.

5

**Select your spreadsheet and sheet (Sheet1)**

Make.com will auto-detect the column headers you created.

6

**Map the fields**

For each column, insert the correct data from previous modules:

| Column    | Data to Insert                                          | Source Module |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Date      | {{now}} (Use Make.com's built-in "now" function)        | Built-in      |
| Name      | {{Name}}                                                | Google Forms  |
| Email     | {{Email}}                                               | Google Forms  |
| Company   | {{Company}}                                             | Google Forms  |
| Budget    | {{Budget}}                                              | Google Forms  |
| Score     | Parse from OpenAI response (the number after "SCORE: ") | OpenAI        |
| Category  | Parse from OpenAI response (Hot/Warm/Cold)              | OpenAI        |
| AI Reason | Parse from OpenAI response (text after "REASON: ")      | OpenAI        |

**How to parse AI response:** The OpenAI module gives you one big text response. To extract just the score or category, you can use Make.com's "Text Parser" module (search for it) with a simple pattern. OR you can just put the entire AI response in one column — simpler for beginners!

7

### Click OK and repeat for the second path

Both hot and cold leads now get saved to the same spreadsheet. The "Category" column tells you which is which.

### Your spreadsheet will look like this:

```
| Date | Name | Email | Company | Budget | Score | Category | AI Reason |
| May 26 | Sarah J. | sarah@co.com | TechCorp | $5,000+ | 9 | Hot | High budget, urgent timeline... |
| May 26 | Bob K. | bob@xyz.com | — | Under $500 | 3 | Cold | Low budget, just exploring... |
```

# 11. Step-by-Step: Test Your Automation

*Before turning it on, we test to make sure everything works perfectly.*

1

## In Make.com, click "Run Once" (bottom-left button)

This puts your automation in "listening mode" — waiting for a test submission.

2

## Open your Google Form in a new tab and submit a HOT LEAD test

Fill it out as if you're a hot lead:

- Name: Test User Hot
- Email: your-real-email@gmail.com (use YOUR email so you can check)
- Company: Test Corp
- Service: Web Design
- Budget: \$5,000+
- Timeline: This week
- Details: "I need a new website for my business ASAP. Ready to start immediately."

3

## Go back to Make.com and watch it run

You'll see each module light up green as it processes. Watch the data flow through:

- Google Forms lights up (data received)
- OpenAI lights up (AI is thinking...)
- Router lights up (checking category...)
- Gmail lights up (sending hot lead email)
- Google Sheets lights up (saving to sheet)

4

## Check your results:

1. Did you receive the "hot lead" email in your inbox?
2. Is the lead saved in your Google Sheet with a high score?
3. Does the AI's reason make sense?

5

**Now test with a COLD LEAD**

Submit the form again but this time:

- Budget: Under \$500
- Timeline: Just exploring
- Details: "I'm just looking around to see what's available."

Verify: Did you get the "nurture" email? Is it scored low in the sheet?

6

**Fix anything that's not working**

Common issues and fixes:

| Problem                   | Fix                                                                  |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| No email received         | Check Gmail module — is the "To" field using the correct variable?   |
| AI gives weird response   | Check your System Prompt — did you copy it exactly?                  |
| Router goes to wrong path | Check your filter condition — does it match "CATEGORY: Hot" exactly? |
| Sheet not updating        | Make sure you selected the correct spreadsheet and sheet name        |
| Email in spam folder      | Normal for first emails. Mark as "Not spam." Will improve over time. |

**If both tests pass:** Congratulations! Your automation works! You're ready to go live.



## 12. Step-by-Step: Turn It On (Go Live)

---

*Make your automation run 24/7 without you touching it.*

1

### **In Make.com, toggle the "Scheduling" switch to ON**

It's at the bottom-left of your scenario. When it's ON, it shows a blue toggle. Your automation is now LIVE.

2

### **Set the schedule interval**

By default, Make.com checks for new form submissions every 15 minutes. For lead gen, this is fine. If you want faster (every 5 minutes), upgrade to a paid plan.

3

### **Share the form link on your website/social media**

Embed the Google Form on your website, add the link to your social media bios, or share it in messages.

4

### **Monitor for the first 24 hours**

Check your Google Sheet and Make.com dashboard to make sure leads are flowing in correctly.

**That's it. Your automation is now running 24/7.** Every form submission gets AI-scored and emailed within minutes. You've built a lead generation machine that works while you sleep.

## 13. How to Improve It Over Time

---

*Once it's running, here's how to make it even better.*

### Level 1: Quick Improvements (Do This Week)

#### Add a Slack/Telegram notification for hot leads

Get instantly notified on your phone when a hot lead comes in. Add a Slack or Telegram module on the hot path: "New HOT lead: {{Name}} (Score: 9). Check your email!"

#### Improve your AI prompt based on real results

After 20-30 leads, review the scores. Is AI scoring too high? Too low? Adjust the scoring rules in your system prompt.

#### Add a "Warm" path

Instead of just Hot and Cold, add a third path for Warm leads (score 4-6) with a medium-urgency email.

### Level 2: Advanced Improvements (Next Month)

#### Add a CRM integration

Instead of (or in addition to) Google Sheets, send leads directly to a CRM like HubSpot, Pipedrive, or Salesforce.

#### Add a follow-up sequence

If a hot lead doesn't reply in 48 hours, automatically send a follow-up email. Add a "Delay" module (wait 48 hours) then another Gmail module.

### **Add a booking link with Calendly**

Instead of "reply to this email," include a Calendly link so hot leads can book a call instantly. Track who books.

### **Score based on website behavior**

Advanced: Track which pages they visited before filling the form. Someone who viewed your pricing page 3 times = extra hot.

## 14. How to Sell This to Clients (\$1,500+)

*You just built something businesses will happily pay thousands for. Here's how to sell it.*

### Who Needs This?

| Business Type              | Why They Need It                                            | What to Charge    |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Real Estate Agents         | Get 50+ property inquiries/day, can't follow up fast enough | \$1,500 - \$3,000 |
| Digital Marketing Agencies | Generate leads for their clients, need to qualify fast      | \$2,000 - \$5,000 |
| Coaches / Consultants      | Get many "discovery call" requests, most are tire-kickers   | \$1,000 - \$2,000 |
| SaaS Companies             | High volume of demo requests, need to prioritize            | \$2,000 - \$4,000 |
| E-commerce Stores          | Wholesale inquiries, custom orders that need qualifying     | \$1,500 - \$3,000 |
| Dental / Medical Clinics   | Patient inquiries need to be categorized and responded to   | \$1,500 - \$2,500 |

### How to Price It

#### Setup Fee: \$1,000 - \$5,000 (one-time)

You build the entire automation, customize it for their business, test it, and hand it over working.

#### Monthly Maintenance: \$200 - \$500/month (recurring)

You monitor it, fix issues, improve prompts, add features. This is where the real money is — recurring income!

## How to Find Clients

1

### Record a Loom demo video (3-5 minutes)

Show your automation working: form submitted AI scores email sent sheet updated. In real-time.

2

### Post on LinkedIn / Twitter

"I built an AI system that qualifies leads and responds in under 60 seconds. Here's a demo: [link]. DM me if you want one for your business."

3

### DM 10 local businesses per day

Find businesses with contact forms on their websites. Message them: "I noticed you have a contact form on your site. I built an AI system that scores every submission and replies instantly. Can I show you a 3-minute demo?"

4

### Offer the first one FREE or heavily discounted

Your first client is for the testimonial and case study. Give them 50% off in exchange for a video testimonial you can use to get more clients.

**Math:** 5 clients × \$2,000 setup + \$300/month maintenance = \$10,000 one-time + \$1,500/month recurring. That's your first \$10K+ month.

## 15. Troubleshooting Common Problems

---

*Things that might go wrong and exactly how to fix them.*

### **Problem: "My automation didn't trigger"**

**Cause:** The scheduling is off, or Google Forms connection broke.

**Fix:** Check that scheduling toggle is ON (blue). Check the Google Forms connection — you may need to reconnect it. Click on the module and verify the connection shows "Connected."

### **Problem: "AI gives weird or inconsistent scores"**

**Cause:** Your prompt is too vague or the AI model is too weak.

**Fix:** Make your scoring rules MORE specific in the prompt. Add examples: "Someone who says '\$5,000+ budget' and 'this week' should ALWAYS be score 8+." Also try switching from gpt-4o-mini to gpt-4o (costs more but smarter).

### **Problem: "The router sends everything to one path"**

**Cause:** Your filter condition doesn't match the AI's response format.

**Fix:** Click on the OpenAI module's output after a test run. Look at the EXACT text AI returns. Then make your router filter match EXACTLY that text. Common issue: extra spaces or line breaks.

### **Problem: "Emails going to spam"**

**Cause:** Gmail sending to strangers often lands in spam initially.

**Fix:** 1) Don't use ALL CAPS in subject lines. 2) Avoid spam words ("FREE", "BUY NOW"). 3) Send from a proper business email (hello@yourbusiness.com vs random123@gmail.com). 4) Over time, as people reply, deliverability improves.

**Problem: "Make.com shows an error on OpenAI module"**

**Cause:** API key expired, rate limit hit, or account has no credits.

**Fix:** Go to [platform.openai.com](https://platform.openai.com) Billing. Make sure you have credits loaded (\$5 minimum). If your key expired, create a new one and update it in Make.com.

**Problem: "I ran out of Make.com free operations"**

**Cause:** Free plan has 1,000 operations/month. Each run uses ~5 operations.

**Fix:** Upgrade to the \$9/month plan (10,000 operations) when you're ready. By the time you hit this limit, you should already have a paying client covering this cost.

**Problem: "Google Sheets not updating"**

**Cause:** Wrong spreadsheet selected, or column headers don't match.

**Fix:** Open the Google Sheets module in Make.com. Verify: correct spreadsheet selected, correct sheet tab (Sheet1), and that your column headers in Row 1 match EXACTLY what you set up.

**Golden Rule:** When something breaks, click on the failed module (it shows red). Read the error message. 90% of the time, the error tells you exactly what's wrong.

## You Did It!

**You now have a complete, working AI Lead Generation Automation.**

It captures leads, scores them with AI, sends personalized emails instantly, and saves everything to a neat spreadsheet.

This exact automation is worth \$1,500-\$5,000 to businesses.

Build it once. Sell it many times.

Total time to build: 45-60 minutes

Monthly cost to run: \$2-\$10

Value to a business: \$1,500-\$5,000 setup + \$200-\$500/month

**Now go build it. Your first client is waiting.**